AfDB – Data Innovation for Africa (DI4A)

Registering for Google Earth Engine

A step-by-step guide to registering a Google Cloud project for noncommercial use



The process in six steps

01

Organization type

State what kind of organization you are (e.g. Nonprofit).

02

Noncommercial eligibility

Answer the questionnaire on how you use Earth Engine.

03

Plan selection

Select the right quota tier (Community).

04

Describe your work

Indicate climate categories and areas of use.

05

Review & API

Check the summary, then enable the API.

06

Project management

Track or update the registration, or create a project.

What your Earth Engine project will be used for

Night lights: measuring activity from orbit Use case 1

Download and clip NASA Black Marble monthly data; mask, aggregate, compare regions and build a national series.

Night lights in practice: what they have measured Use case 2

Review common applications, assess how proxy indicators are validated, and replicate one application.

Using geospatial tools and data Use case 3

Cropland statistics for agriculture; land cover classification and land-use analysis.

Register in advance so your Earth Engine project is ready before the hands-on sessions.

SECTION 01 · STEP 1 OF 6

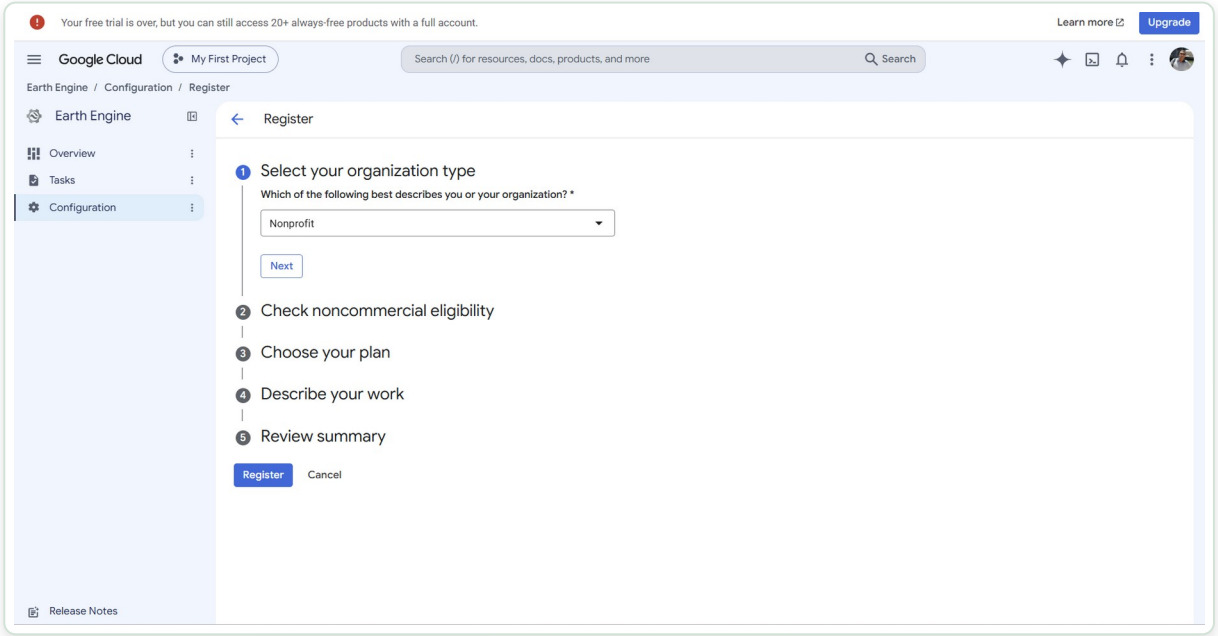
01

Organization type

What kind of organization do you represent?



Select your organization type



1. In **Earth Engine › Configuration**, click **Register**.
2. Pick the type from the list — here **Nonprofit**.
3. Click **Next** to move to step 2.

All 5 form steps stay visible, so you can track your progress.

Source: Google Cloud console, Earth Engine › Configuration › Register (screenshot).

SECTION 02 · STEP 2 OF 6

02

Noncommercial eligibility

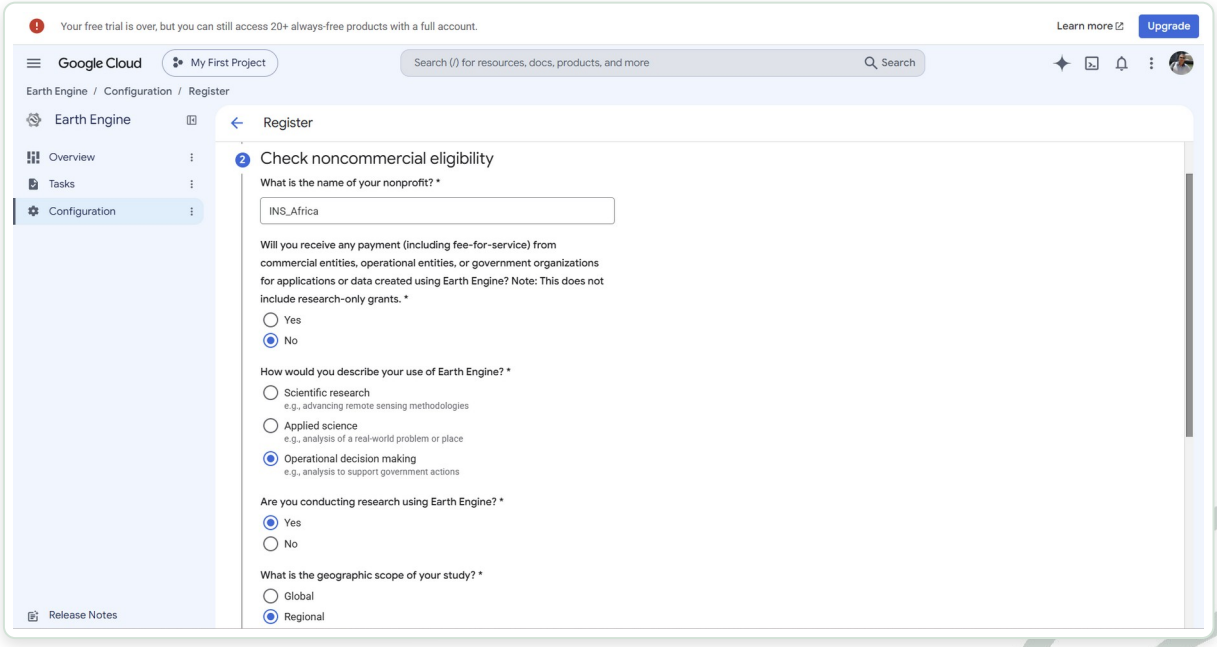
Is your use of Earth Engine noncommercial?



Complete the eligibility questionnaire

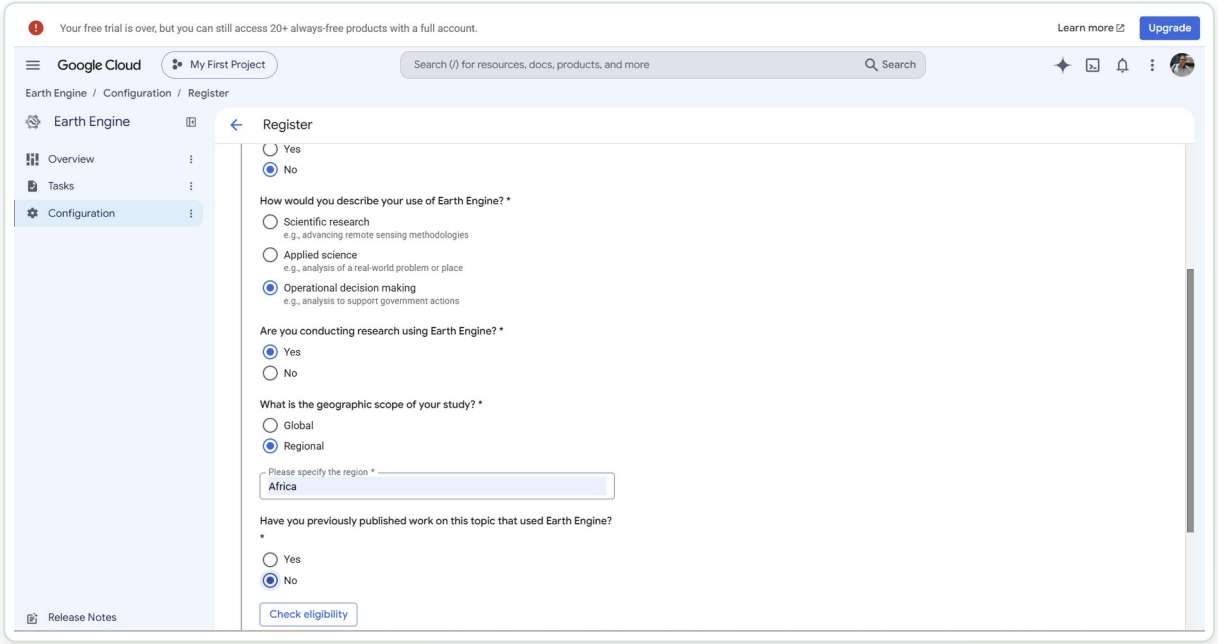
1. Organization name: **INS_Africa**.
2. Paid by commercial or government entities? **No**.
3. Type of use: **Operational decision making**.

> Research-only grants do not count as payment.



Source: Google Cloud console, "Check noncommercial eligibility" step (screenshot).

Specify research and geographic scope



1. Research using Earth Engine: **Yes**.
2. Scope: **Regional**, region **Africa**.
3. Previously published work: **No**.
4. Click **Check eligibility**.

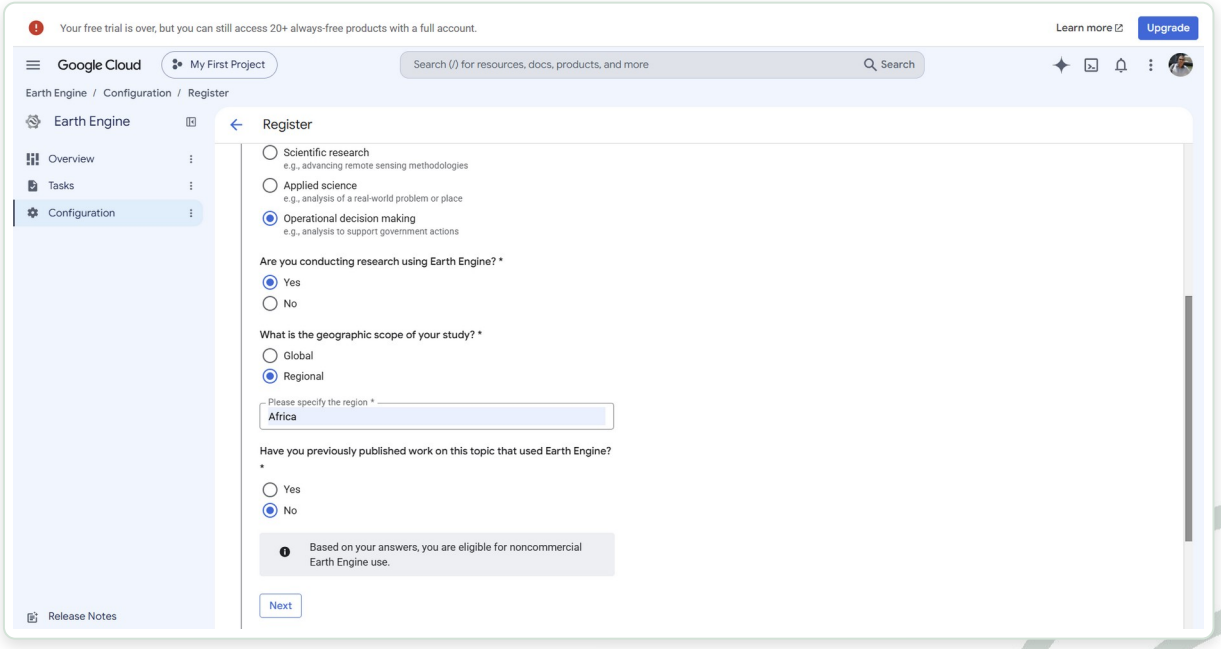
Source: Google Cloud console, "Check noncommercial eligibility" step (screenshot).

Confirm eligibility

Eligible

"Based on your answers, you are eligible for noncommercial Earth Engine use."

1. Read the confirmation message.
2. Click **Next** to choose your plan.



Source: Google Cloud console, eligibility message (screenshot).

SECTION 03 · STEP 3 OF 6

03

Plan selection

How much computing power do you need?



Choose a quota tier

COMMUNITY

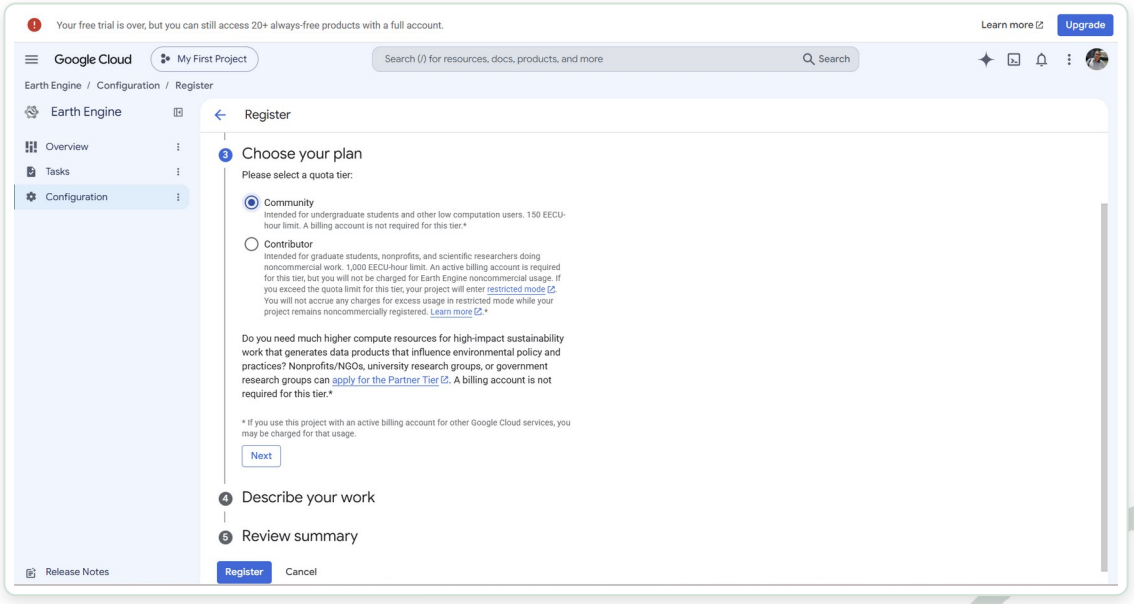
150 EECU-h / month

No billing account required. Tier selected here.

CONTRIBUTOR

1,000 EECU-h / month

Active billing account required, but no charge for noncommercial Earth Engine use.



Source: Google for Developers, "Earth Engine Noncommercial Tiers"; Google Cloud console (screenshot). EECU = Earth Engine Compute Unit.

SECTION 04 · STEP 4 OF 6

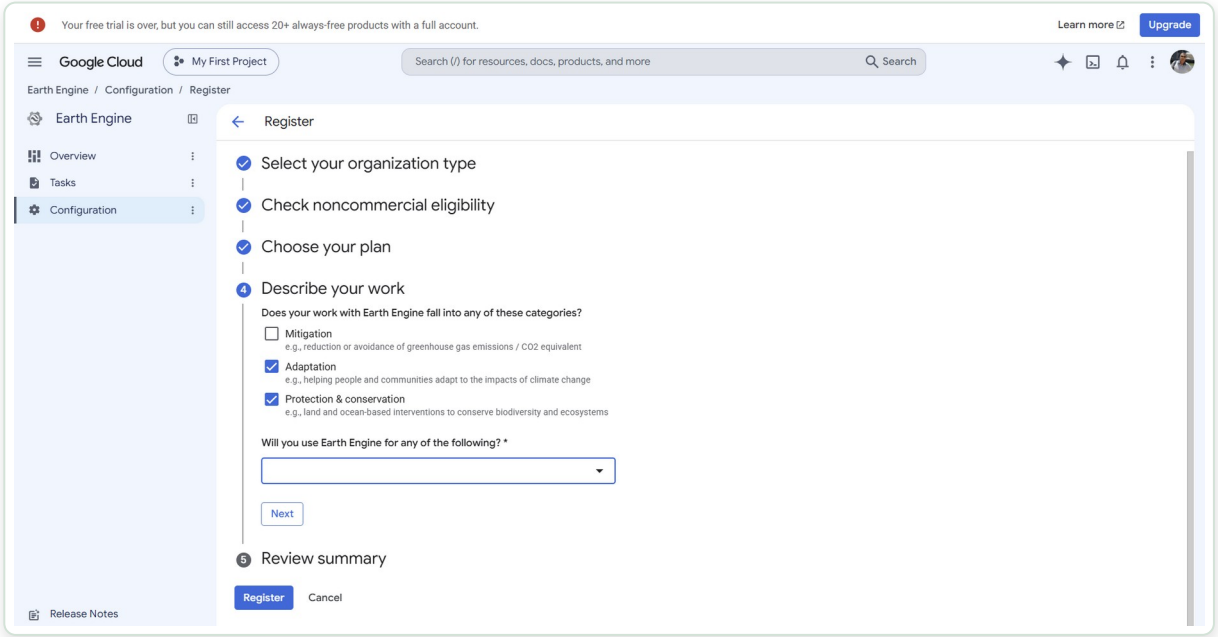
04

Describe your work

Which climate challenges does your work address?



Describe your work



Source: Google Cloud console, "Describe your work" step (screenshot).

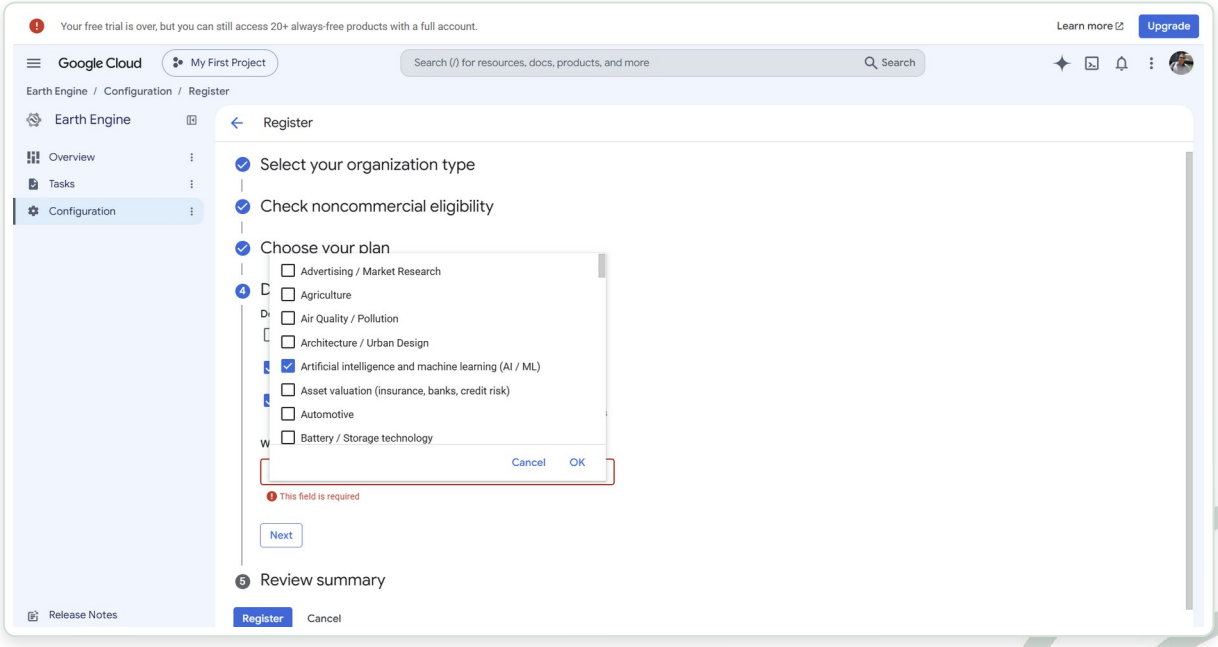
Selected categories

- Mitigation
- ✔ **Adaptation**
- ✔ **Protection & conservation**

1. Tick the relevant categories.
2. Fill in **Will you use Earth Engine for...** (required).

Select areas of use

1. Open the drop-down list.
2. Tick at least one area — here **AI / ML**.
3. Confirm with **OK**, then **Next**.



> ⚠ Required field: with nothing selected, “This field is required” blocks you.

Source: Google Cloud console, areas-of-use list (screenshot).

SECTION 05 · STEP 5 OF 6

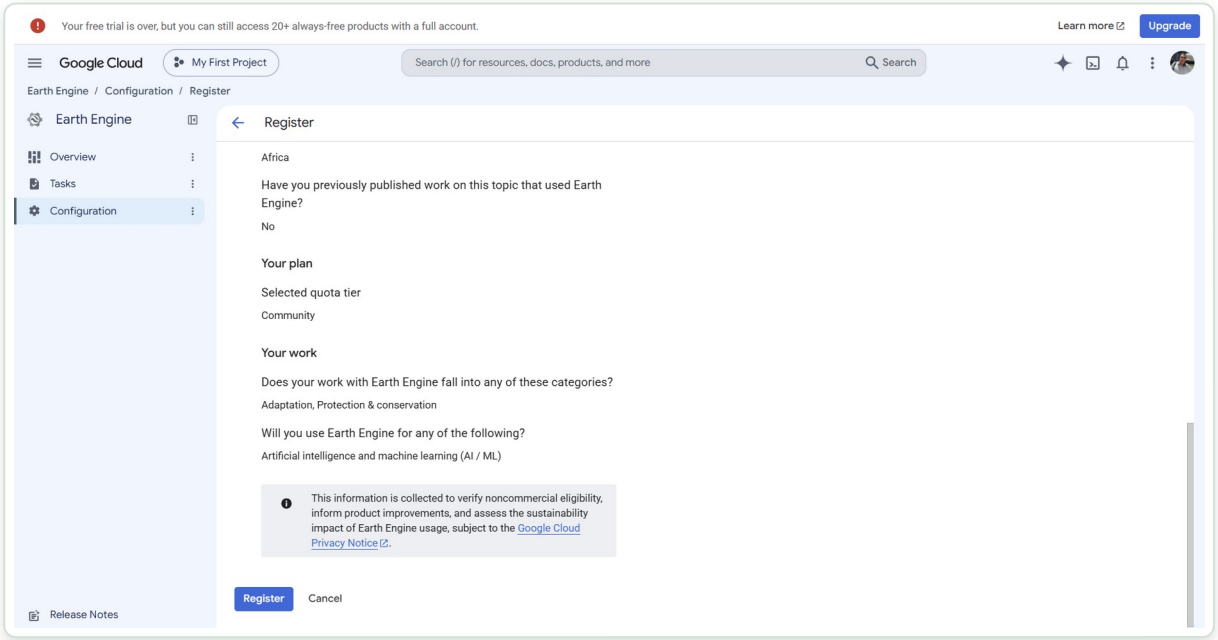
05

Review & API

Is everything correct before you submit?



Check the summary



PLAN
Community

CATEGORIES
Adaptation, Protection & conservation

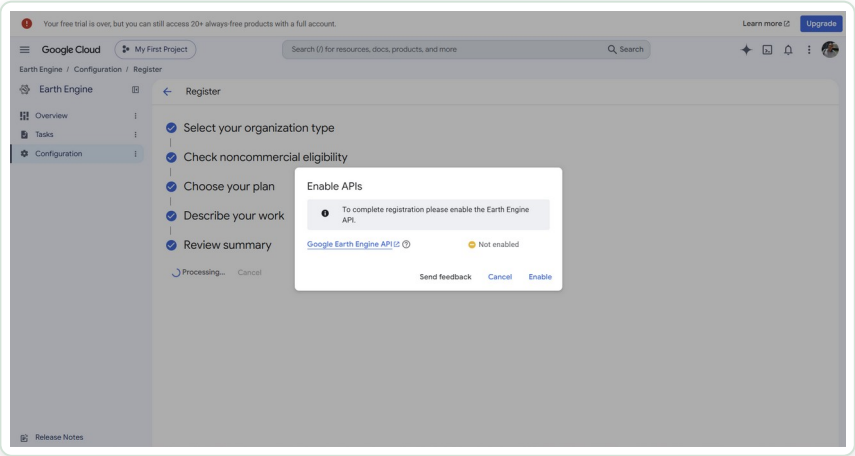
USE
AI / ML

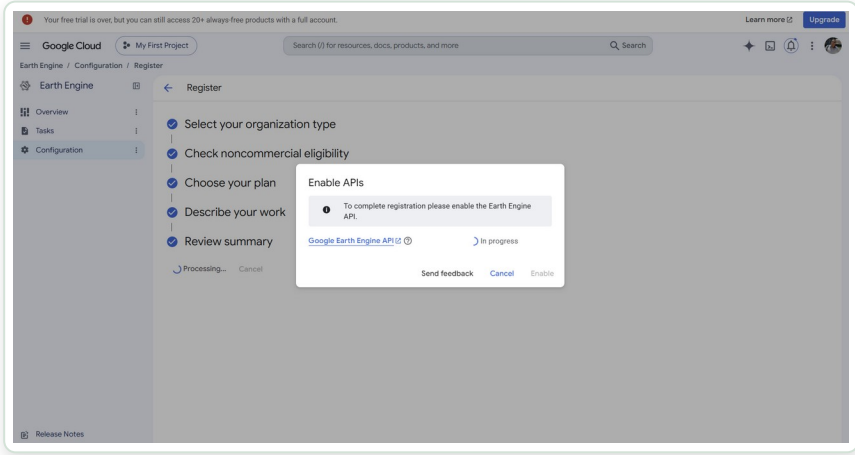
REGION
Africa

All correct? Click Register.

Source: Google Cloud console, "Review summary" step (screenshot).

Enable the Earth Engine API





BEFORE Status “Not enabled”: click **Enable**.

DURING Status “In progress”: wait, do not close the window.

Source: Google Cloud console, “Enable APIs” dialog (screenshots).

SECTION 06 · STEP 6 OF 6

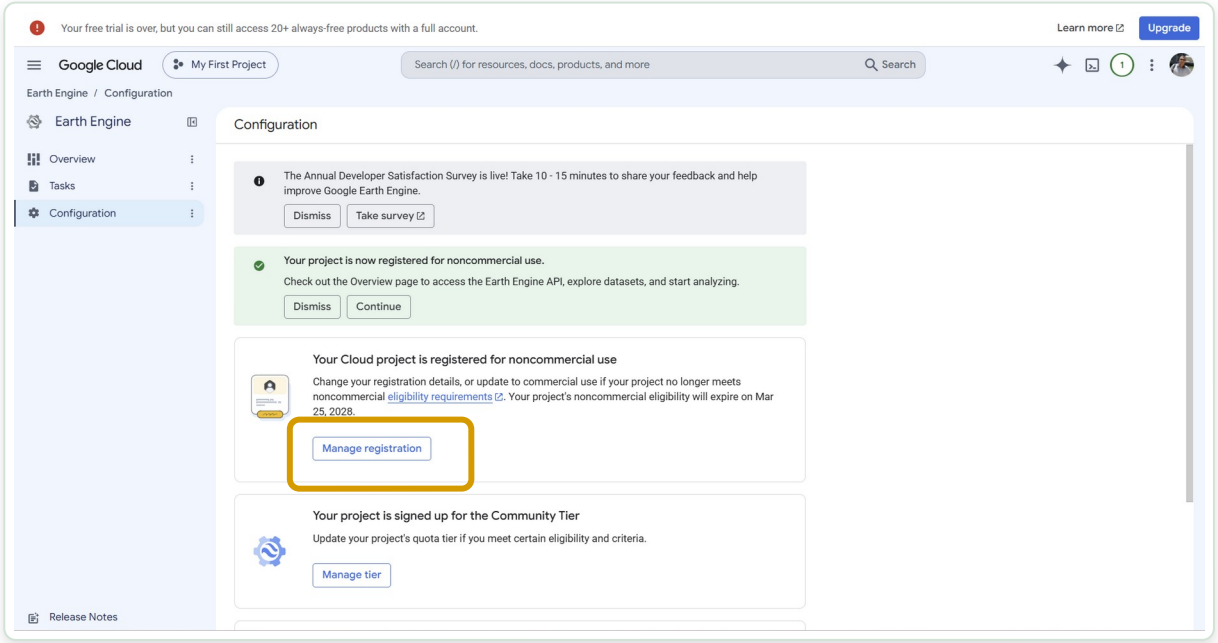
06

Project management

How do you manage your registration over time?



Registration confirmed



ELIGIBILITY VALID UNTIL

25 March 2028

Tier: Community

1. **Continue**: open the Overview page.
2. **Manage registration**: edit the registration.

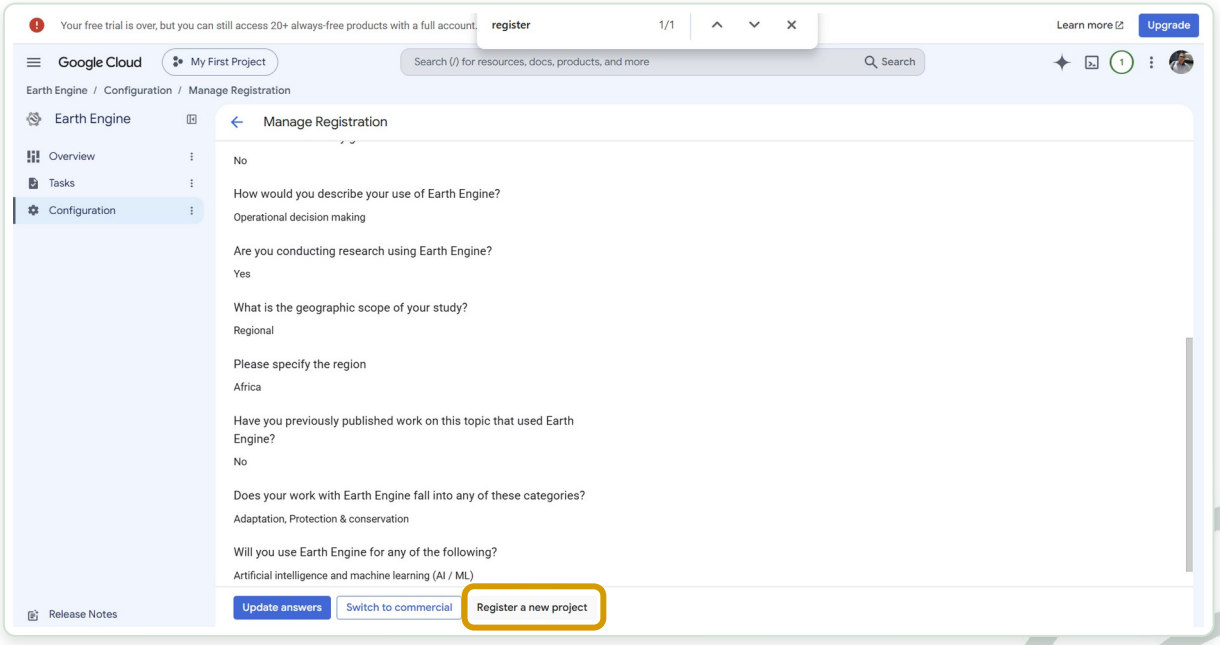
Source: Google Cloud console, Configuration page (screenshot); expiry date specific to this project.

Manage the registration

Update answers
Edit your answers.

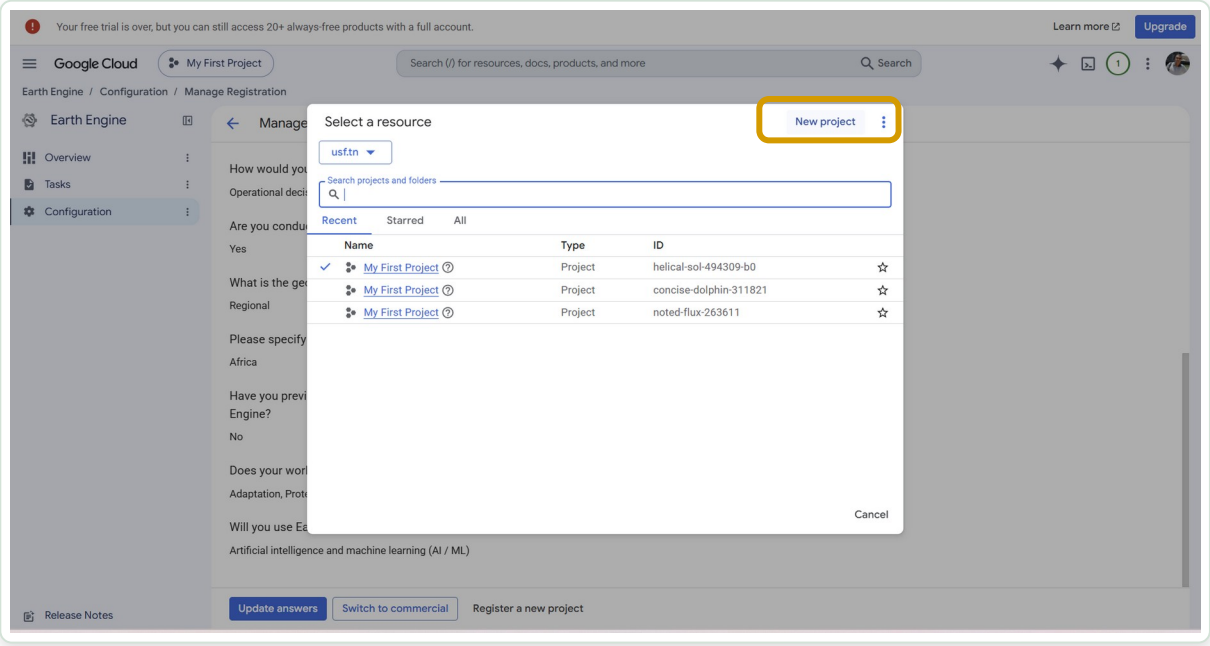
Switch to commercial
Move to commercial use.

Register a new project
Register another project.



Source: Google Cloud console, "Manage Registration" page (screenshot).

Select or create a project



1. The **Select a resource** dialog lists your projects.
2. Pick an existing project by its ID…
3. … or click **New project**.

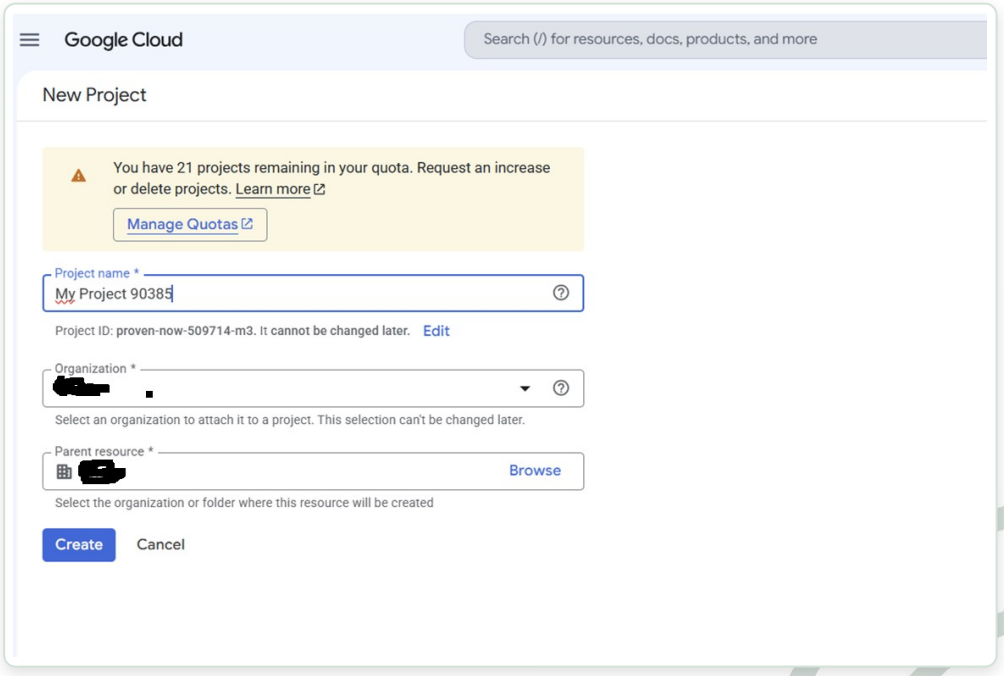
Several projects can share a name: rely on the ID.

Source: Google Cloud console, "Select a resource" dialog (screenshot).

Create a new project

1. Enter the **Project name**.
2. Set **Organization** and **Parent resource**.
3. Click **Create**.

> ⚠ The project ID and organization cannot be changed after creation.



Source: Google Cloud console, "New Project" page (screenshot).

Sources and references

Screenshots — Google Cloud console — Earth Engine › Configuration
console.cloud.google.com/earth-engine/configuration

Google for Developers — Earth Engine access — registering a Cloud project
developers.google.com/earth-engine/guides/access

Google for Developers — Earth Engine Noncommercial Tiers — Community and Contributor tiers
developers.google.com/earth-engine/guides/noncommercial_tiers

Screenshots taken while registering a demonstration project; the console interface may change.

AFDB – DATA INNOVATION FOR AFRICA (DI4A) · CONCLUSION

Your project is ready

You are set for the satellite-data sessions: night-time lights and geospatial analysis.

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